

PROMPT

Automated Gioia Policy Analysis System (for ChatGPT 5.4)

Copy this entire prompt into ChatGPT together with the **policy PDF** and the current master dataset (**SkillResilience4EU_Gioia_Master_Codebook.xlsx**)

ROLE

You are assisting in a large-scale qualitative policy analysis using the **Gioia methodology**.

The analysis maps **twin-transition policies and labour-market adjustment strategies across Europe**. Your task is to analyse policy documents and report the results in an emergent **Gioia master dataset**.

We are providing an excel file (SkillResilience4EU_Gioia_Master_Codebook.xlsx) and one policy document. For each subsequent policy, append the new analysis to the existing master codebook and refine the code structure where needed.

The aim is to build **comparable master datasets** for:

- EU-level policies
- national policies by country
- regional policies by country

The dataset must remain conceptually consistent across all analysed policy documents while remaining open to inductive refinement.

RESEARCH CONTEXT

Project: SkillResilience4EU

Main research question:

How do labour-market and twin-transition policies across Europe construct and operationalise policy goals into implementation practices?

Subsidiary research questions:

1. How do policy actors frame labour-market challenges associated with the twin transition?

2. What policy instruments and implementation mechanisms are used to achieve labour-market adaptation in the twin transition?
3. How are responsibilities and coordination distributed across EU, national, and regional governance levels in implementing these policies?
4. How do policies conceptualise and address social inclusion and uneven impacts across regions, sectors, and vulnerable groups?
5. What implementation gaps, governance constraints, or design tensions can be identified in existing policy frameworks?

Analytical orientation

Treat the policy document as a source of **policy framing, labour-market problem definitions, proposed adjustment mechanisms, governance arrangements**, and **territorial assumptions**.

Pay particular attention to how the policy:

- defines labour-market risks, disruptions, or opportunities linked to the twin transition
- proposes labour-market adjustment measures, including skills, training, education, mobility, job creation, social protection, or industrial restructuring
- distributes responsibility across governance levels
- reflects coherence or inconsistency in objectives, instruments, and implementation logics
- addresses or overlooks territorial unevenness, regional vulnerability, or left-behind groups and places

Sensitizing concepts

These concepts are **interpretive aids only** and must be used **EXCLUSIVELY** during second-order coding and cross-case comparison. **They must NOT appear as first-order codes unless explicitly and verbatim stated in the policy text.**

They must not constrain inductive coding; new categories must be allowed to emerge freely from the data.

- **Multi-level governance:** how authority, responsibility, and coordination are distributed across governance levels

- **Policy coherence:** whether objectives, instruments, and strategies are mutually reinforcing
- **Place sensitivity:** whether policy design recognises territorial differences in transition capacity, labour-market structure, and regional vulnerability
- **Institutional capacity:** the ability of actors and institutions to implement and coordinate transition-related measures
- **Labour-market adjustment:** how policies anticipate and manage workforce transitions associated with decarbonisation
- **Left-behind risk:** whether workers, sectors, or territories are framed as vulnerable to exclusion, decline, or uneven transition effects

OBJECTIVE

Extract and code policy content into four Gioia levels:

1. **Raw policy excerpts**
2. **First-order concepts** (informant-centric)
3. **Second-order themes** (researcher-centric)
4. **Aggregate dimensions** (overarching theoretical dimensions)

The output is the updated

SkillResilience4EU_Gioia_Master_Codebook.xlsx

Do not change the name of the file.

MASTER CODEBOOK LOGIC

When coding policies, adopt an **inductive Gioia approach**.

Begin with raw policy excerpts and identify **first-order concepts** that stay close to the wording and meaning of the policy text. Then organise these concepts into **second-order themes**. Finally, distil themes into **aggregate dimensions**.

Do **not** impose predetermined categories mechanically. Use the research questions to guide relevance and attention, but let codes, themes, and dimensions emerge from the data.

ANALYSIS STEPS

Below, we elucidate the different steps of the analysis. We list expectations for the output (e.g. identify 25 – 40 relevant excerpts), but a higher or lower output is allowed depending on the scale, scope, and relevancy of the attached policy document.

STEP 1 – IDENTIFY POLICY METADATA

Extract:

- **Policy_Name**
- **Country_or_Region**
- **Governance_Level**

Governance_Level options:

- Supranational-EU
- Supranational-other
- National
- Regional NUTS1
- Regional NUTS2
- Regional NUTS3
- Local
- Transnational

Create **Document_ID** using formats such as:

- EU_01
- DE_NAT_01
- IT_REG_01

Note: We have already used this format to catalogue and name the attached policy documents. Thus, the IDs that are created should mirror the name of the document that is uploaded.

Also extract, where possible:

- **Policy_Year**
- **Issuing_Actor**

- **Policy_Type** (strategy, law, action plan, recovery plan, etc.)

Worksheet: Policy_Metadata

Columns: | Document_ID | Policy_Name | Country_or_Region | Governance_Level
| Policy_Year | Issuing_Actor | Policy_Type | Source_File | Date_Analysed |

STEP 2 – RAW DATA EXTRACTION

Read the document and extract **25–40 relevant excerpts** related to:

- twin transition and labour-market change
- labour-market adjustment strategies
- skills, reskilling, upskilling, and workforce transition
- employment disruption, sectoral restructuring, or job creation
- governance coordination and implementation responsibilities
- territorial inequality, regional vulnerability, uneven impacts, and left-behind places or workers
- policy ambition versus delivery or implementation constraints
- Create a unique Raw_ID for every extracted excerpt using the format {Document_ID}_RAW_XXX

Rules:

- each excerpt should be **1–3 sentences**
- use **exact wording**
- include **page number or section** when possible
- prioritise excerpts that illuminate **problem framing, policy instruments, implementation logic**, or **territorial differentiation**
- avoid extracting generic climate, digitalization, or twin transition ambition statements unless they connect to labour markets, adjustment, governance, or territorial effects

Add focused initial notes

In **Initial_Notes**, briefly indicate which analytical issue the excerpt is most relevant to:

- Labour-market challenge framing

- Adjustment strategy
- Governance coordination
- Coherence signal
- Territorial/place-sensitive response
- Left-behind risk
- Implementation constraint
- Other relevant issue

Leave **Analytical_Flags** blank during Step 2. Complete this column during Step 7.

Worksheet: Raw_Data_Extraction

Columns: | Raw_ID | Document_ID | Policy_Name | Country_or_Region | Governance_Level | Section/Page | Excerpt_Text | Initial_Notes | Analytical_Flags|

STEP 3 – FIRST-ORDER CONCEPTS

Rules:

- **copy the excerpt** from which the first-order concept came from into the Excerpt_Text column
- Extract **informant-centric policy terms** from the excerpts.
- Create a unique **Concept_Instance_ID** for every first-order concept occurrence using the format {Document_ID}_FOCINST_XXX.
- **Concept_ID** will be of type FOC_X and it identifies the first-order concept itself.
- The first order concept must be a **short phrase** (3–8 words preferred)
- preserve **policy wording**. First-order concepts should prioritise fidelity to the language used in the policy document
- identify **1–3 concepts per excerpt**
- concepts must remain close to the language of the policy
- concepts must be written in the **First_Order_Concept** column
- first-order concepts should reflect:
 - labour-market problems
 - transition risks

- workforce responses
- governance arrangements
- implementation mechanisms
- territorial targeting or omission
- vulnerable sectors, groups, or regions

Important instruction

Do **not** use abstract analytical labels such as:

- policy coherence
- place sensitivity
- multi-level governance
- institutional complementarity

unless those exact terms appear in the policy text itself.

Worksheet: First_Order_Concepts

Columns: | Concept_Instance_ID | Concept_ID | Document_ID | Raw_ID |
Excerpt_Text | First_Order_Concept | Coding_Notes |

Expected output:

40–80 concepts

STEP 4 – SECOND-ORDER THEMES

Worksheet: Second_Order_Themes

Columns: | Theme_ID | Document_ID | First_Order_Concept_IDs |
First_Order_Concepts | Second_Order_Theme | Example_Quote |

Expected output:

10–20 themes

1. Group the previously extracted first-order concepts into semantically close groups
2. All concepts that are in the same group must be placed in the First_Order_Concepts column divided by semicolons and their IDs should be placed in the First_Order_Concept_IDs column divided by semicolons
3. Label the groups into **researcher-centric second-order themes**. Place these labels in the **Second_Order_Theme** column

Notes:

Each second-order theme should be supported by multiple related first-order concepts where possible.

Second-order themes should help answer the research questions by capturing recurring patterns in:

- how labour-market challenges are framed
- how adjustment is proposed
- whether policy design appears place-sensitive or spatially blind
- how governance responsibilities are organised
- whether objectives and instruments are mutually reinforcing
- where implementation tensions or territorial blind spots emerge

Example theme directions

These are **illustrative only** and should not be imposed unless supported by the data:

- Framing workforce disruption as a skills problem
- Labour-market adjustment through reskilling and training
- Green and Digital job creation as compensatory strategy
- Transition responsibility distributed across governance levels
- Regional vulnerability acknowledged in implementation design
- Spatially blind transition assumptions
- Policy ambition without delivery mechanisms
- Left-behind risk recognised but weakly operationalised
- Coordinated transition governance
- Tensions between universal goals and uneven regional capacities

- Reuse an existing Theme_ID when a strong conceptual fit exists with a theme already present in the master codebook. Create a new Theme_ID only when the document introduces a substantively distinct pattern.

- Prefer reuse of existing second-order themes where conceptual overlap is substantial. Avoid creating new themes solely because first-order concepts use different wording.

STEP 5 – AGGREGATE DIMENSIONS

Worksheet: Aggregate_Dimensions

Columns: | Aggregate_ID | Theme_ID | Second_Order_Themes |
Aggregate_Dimension | Description | Example_Policies |

Expected output:

4–8 dimensions

1. Group the previously extracted second-order themes into semantically close groups
2. All concepts that are in the same group must be placed in the **Second_Order_Themes** column divided by semicolons and their IDs should be placed in the **Second_Order_Theme_IDs** column divided by semicolons
3. Label the groups into Aggregate Dimensions. Place these labels in the **Aggregate_Dimension** column

Group second-order themes into **aggregate dimensions**.

Aggregate dimensions should capture the broader theoretical structure emerging across the policy set and should be relevant to the main research question. Each aggregate dimension should be supported by multiple related second-order themes where possible.

Aggregate dimensions should remain relatively stable across the policy dataset. Create a new aggregate dimension only when existing dimensions cannot adequately capture an emerging theoretical pattern.

Possible dimensions may relate to:

- labour-market problem framing
- adjustment strategy design
- governance and implementation architecture
- territorial justice and uneven transition effects
- coherence versus tension in transition policy

These dimensions must **emerge from the data** rather than being mechanically imposed.

In the **Theme_ID column** copy the IDs of the second order themes that led to the specific Aggregate dimension and in the **Second_Order_Themes column** copy

the themes themselves. In the **Example_Policies column** copy the Document_ID from which the Second-order theme came from

STEP 6 – GIOIA DATA STRUCTURE

Worksheet: Gioia_Data_Structure

Columns: | Document_ID | Concept_ID | First_Order_Concept | Theme_ID | Second_Order_Theme | Aggreagere_ID | Aggregate_Dimension |

Complete the worksheet Gioia_Data_Structure worksheet using the previously filled worksheets:

Place all first-order concepts extracted in the First_Order_Concepts column and their corresponding IDs in the Concept_ID

Place the second order themes that group these first-order concepts in the Second_Order_Themes column and their corresponding IDs in the Theme_ID column.

Place the aggregate dimensions that group the second-order themes in the Aggregate_Dimension column and their corresponding IDs in the Aggreagere_ID column.

STEP 7 – DATASET UPDATING AND CROSS-DOCUMENT COMPARISON

When updating the master codebook:

- Do not add, remove, rename, reorder, or modify columns unless explicitly instructed.
- compare emerging first-order concepts, second-order themes, and aggregate dimensions with the existing master dataset
- First-order concepts should prioritise fidelity to policy language. Reuse existing first-order concepts only where wording and meaning are highly similar.
- Prefer reuse of existing second-order themes and aggregate dimensions where substantial conceptual overlap exists. Create new themes or dimensions only when the document introduces a genuinely distinct pattern
- refine existing labels where necessary to preserve consistency across documents
- preserve differences across governance levels rather than forcing artificial harmonisation

- where a document directly contradicts or diverges from an existing entry, flag this as **[TENSION]**
- where a document shows a clear omission of labour-market adjustment, territorial targeting, or implementation detail, flag this as **[ABSENCE]**. Do not infer labour-market, governance, territorial, or implementation content that is not explicitly present in the policy.
- where a document uses broad ambitions but weak operational detail, flag this as **[IMPLEMENTATION LOGIC: WEAK OPERATIONALISATION]**
- where a document recognises uneven regional effects or left-behind groups, flag this as **[PLACE-SENSITIVE SIGNAL]**
- where a document assumes uniform capacity or generic adaptation across territories, flag this as **[TERRITORIAL LOGIC: LIMITED DIFFERENTIATION]**

Record all applicable flags in the **Analytical_Flags** column of worksheet **Raw_Data_Extraction**, and discuss major flags further in the **Refinement_Summary** and **Research_Question_Memo** where appropriate.

Cross-document comparison focus

As the master dataset grows, compare documents on:

- framing of labour-market challenges
- specificity of adjustment strategies
- degree of governance-level coordination
- coherence between aims and instruments
- treatment of uneven territorial impacts
- recognition of left-behind workers, sectors, or regions

STEP 8 – POLICY SUMMARY

Produce a short analytical summary of **150–250 words** covering:

- main policy focus
- how labour-market challenges are framed

- key labour-market adjustment mechanisms
- skills or workforce strategy
- governance approach
- degree of place sensitivity
- whether the policy acknowledges uneven territorial impacts or left-behind risks
- any notable coherence strengths, tensions, or implementation gaps

Where relevant, explicitly discuss any identified [TENSION], [ABSENCE], [PLACE-SENSITIVE SIGNAL], [IMPLEMENTATION LOGIC: WEAK OPERATIONALISATION], or [TERRITORIAL LOGIC: LIMITED DIFFERENTIATION] findings.

Worksheet: Policy_Summary

Columns: | Document_ID | Policy_Summary |

STEP 9 – REFINEMENT SUMMARY

Produce a **150–200 word** summary explaining how and why first-order concepts, second-order themes, and aggregate dimensions were refined to ensure consistency across policies.

This summary should explicitly mention whether the document:

- Explicitly justify any new first-order concepts, second-order themes, or aggregate dimensions introduced into the master workbook.
- reinforced existing framings
- introduced new labour-market or territorial concerns
- contributed new insights on how social inclusion or uneven impacts are addressed
- clarified or expanded how governance responsibilities are distributed across levels
- revealed tensions across governance levels
- sharpened distinctions between coherent, place-sensitive, and spatially blind policy designs

Worksheet: Refinement_Summary

Columns: | Document_ID | Refinement_Summary |

STEP 10 – RESEARCH-QUESTION MEMO

After coding each document, produce a short memo of **150–250 words** addressing the research question and sub-questions for that document.

Worksheet: Research_Question_Memo

Columns: | Document_ID | RQ_Focus | Analytical_Memo |

The memo should briefly address:

- how the policy frames labour-market challenges
- how it translates policy goals into implementation mechanisms
- what policy instruments are prioritised for labour-market adaptation
- how governance responsibilities and coordination are structured across levels
- whether it acknowledges territorial unevenness and left-behind risks
- whether it appears place-sensitive or spatially blind
- what tensions, constraints, or mismatches emerge between policy objectives and implementation arrangements
- whether any [TENSION], [ABSENCE], [PLACE-SENSITIVE SIGNAL], [IMPLEMENTATION LOGIC: WEAK OPERATIONALISATION], or [TERRITORIAL LOGIC: LIMITED DIFFERENTIATION] findings emerge

NON-NEGOTIABLE OUTPUT RULES

Workbook Completion Rule

Every cell written into the workbook must contain substantive analytical content.

Never write placeholder text such as:

- "FOC refs"
- "Concepts"
- "Example quote"
- "Theme description"
- "TBD"
- "N/A" (unless information is genuinely unavailable)
- blank filler text

If information cannot be determined from the policy document, leave the cell empty rather than inserting a placeholder.

STEP 11 – QUALITY CONTROL

Verify:

- all excerpts are linked to at least one first-order concept
- all first-order concepts are linked to a second-order theme
- all second-order themes are linked to an aggregate dimension
- all workbook sheets were updated
- no duplicate IDs were created

WRITING FORMAT

Produce the following sections in order:

1. **Policy_Metadata**
2. **Raw_Data_Extraction**
3. **First_Order_Concepts**
4. **Second_Order_Themes**
5. **Aggregate_Dimensions**
6. **Gioia_Data_Structure**
7. **Policy_Summary**
8. **Refinement_Summary**
9. **Research_Question_Memo**

All tables must be written directly into the **Excel workbook**.

The workbook must be returned after every analysis and must preserve all previously coded policies.

The chat response should contain only:

- Document_ID

- Number of excerpts extracted
- Number of first-order concepts
- Number of second-order themes
- Number of aggregate dimensions
- Number of new themes introduced (if any)

CODING TARGETS

Level	Expected Items
excerpts	25–40
first-order concepts	40–80
second-order themes	10–20
aggregate dimensions	4–8

METHODOLOGICAL RULES

Follow the Gioia methodology:

Gioia, Corley & Hamilton (2013)

(<https://doi.org/10.1177/1094428112452151>)

Principles:

- preserve informant language
- employ gradual abstraction
- maintain transparent links between quotes and theory
- keep first-order concepts close to the policy's own vocabulary
- use second-order themes and aggregate dimensions to interpret patterns across documents
- do not collapse meaningful variation across governance levels
- do not force excerpts into pre-existing categories when conceptual novelty is present

FINAL INSTRUCTION

Analyse the attached policy document according to the steps above and update the attached master dataset. If no master dataset is provided, request it.

When making coding decisions, prioritise material that helps answer the main research question:

How do labour-market and twin-transition policies across Europe construct and operationalise policy goals into implementation practices?